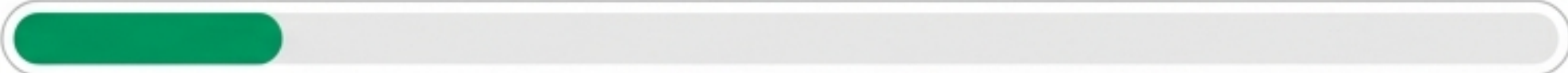


THE VELOCITY CRISIS: DECEMBER 2025 SYSTEMIC THREAT OVERVIEW

STRATEGIC INTELLIGENCE // EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

eCrime Breakout Time (Compromise to Lateral Movement)



48 MINUTES

Source: Global Cyber Threat Intelligence Strategic Monthly Trend Report: Dec 2025

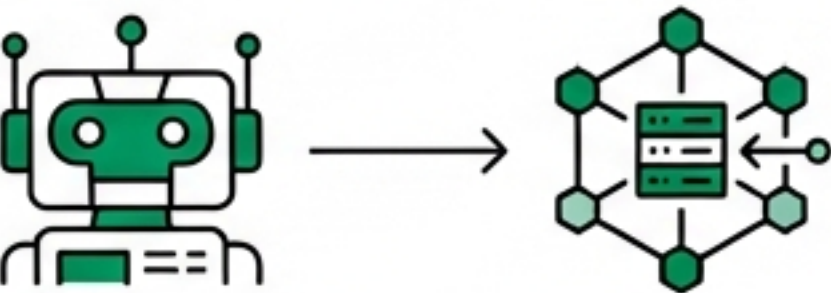
Publicly Claimed Ransomware Victims (December 2025)

839



Second most active month of the year.

Agentic AI Maturity



Autonomous agents now navigating network topologies and bypassing MFA via session-hijacking without human intervention.

Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Operational Latency: Traditional SOC responses are too slow. The 48-minute breakout time demands immediate adoption of autonomous, machine-speed defense capabilities.

Critical Infrastructure Breach: French Ministry of the Interior ('Beauvau')



Root Cause

Not a Zero-Day. Driven by credential negligence and fundamental hygiene failures, exposing fragility in state-level perimeters.

Data Exposure Impact

Access to Criminal Records Processing System (TAJ) and Wanted Persons File (FPR).

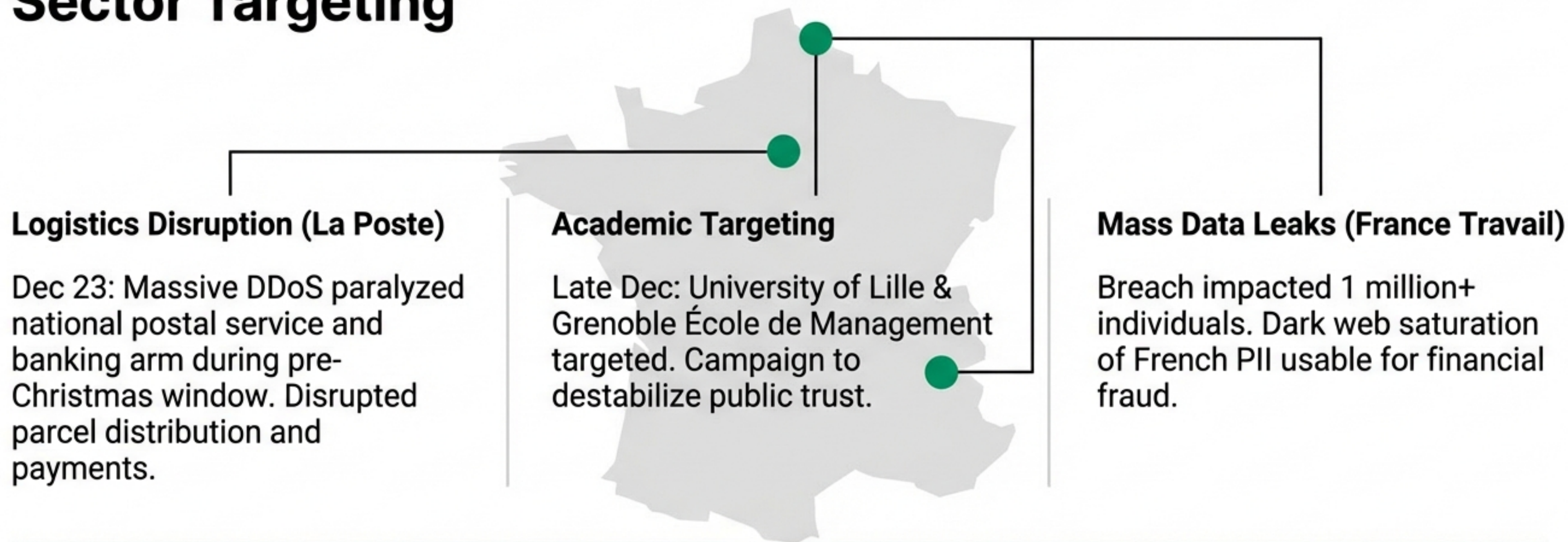
16.4 Million

Citizens' PII Potentially Exposed

Key Risk for Bank Leadership

KYC/AML Integrity: The compromise of official watchlists undermines automated background checks. Risk of sanctioned entities bypassing compliance filters using 'clean' 'identities derived from this breach.'

Regional Contagion: Escalation in French Public Sector Targeting

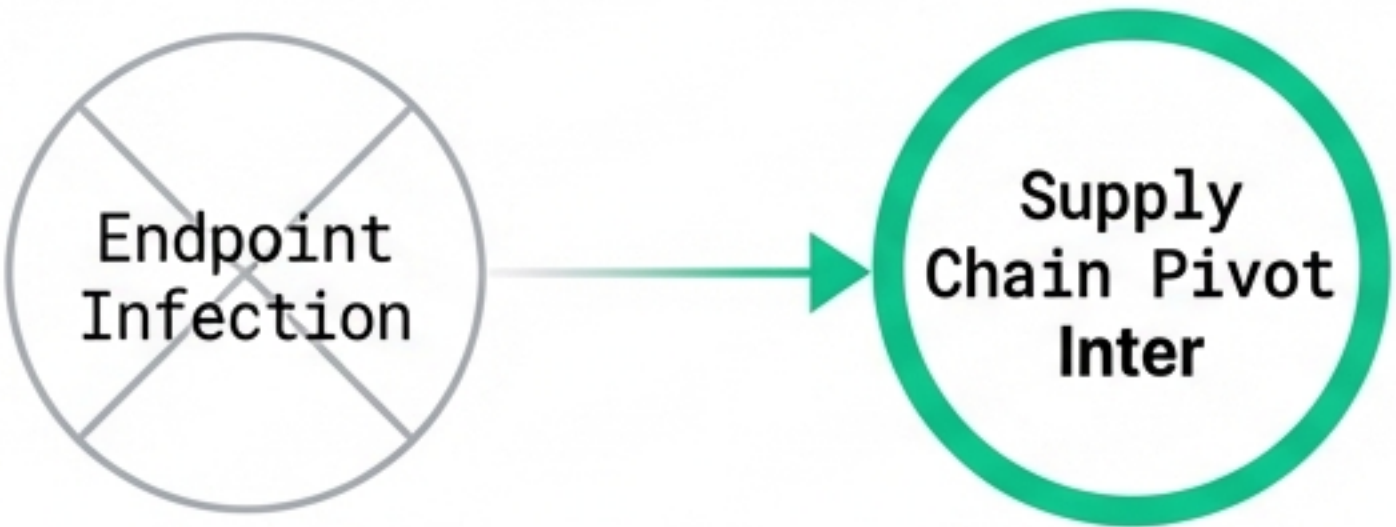


Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Third-Party Exposure

Destabilization of national infrastructure providers increases 'ripple effect' disruptions to bank logistics (card delivery) and payroll operations.

Adversary Profile: Everest Group's Supply Chain Pivot

The Pivot Strategy



Strategic shift to 'Big Game Hunting' by targeting technology providers to access downstream financial clients.

Recent High-Value Targets

- Fintech: Exegy, Inc.** December 2
Leader in low-latency market data. Attack threatens proprietary trading data of institutional clients.
- Automotive: Nissan Motor Corp**
900GB exfiltrated. All data released on dark web after negotiations failed. Ruthless extortion tactics confirmed.

Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Vendor Contagion

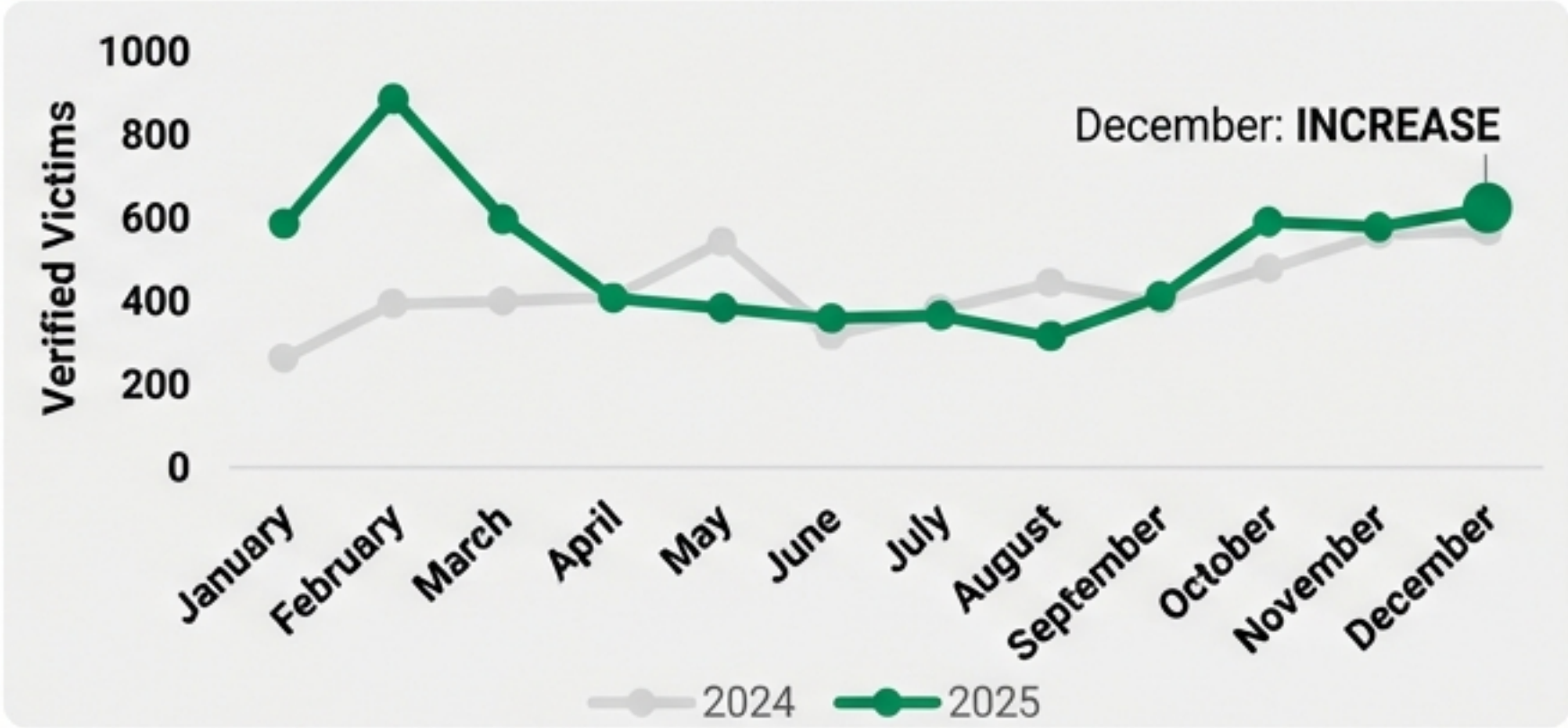
Everest's compromise of Exegy proves capability to penetrate high-speed trading infrastructure. Immediate vendor risk assessment required for all fintech partners.

Validated Threat Trends: December 2025 Statistics

Threat Vector	Trend	Detail
Phishing	INCREASE	Surge in 'ClickFix' PowerShell technique.
Ransomware	INCREASE	839 Verified Victims (2nd highest month).
Banking Trojans	INCREASE	Anatsa targeting 831 financial institutions.
DDoS	INCREASE	Multi-terabit floods (La Poste, UK).
BEC	INCREASE	Rise in AI-fabricated email chains & voice cloning.
Account Takeover	INCREASE	520% surge in automated traffic to retail.

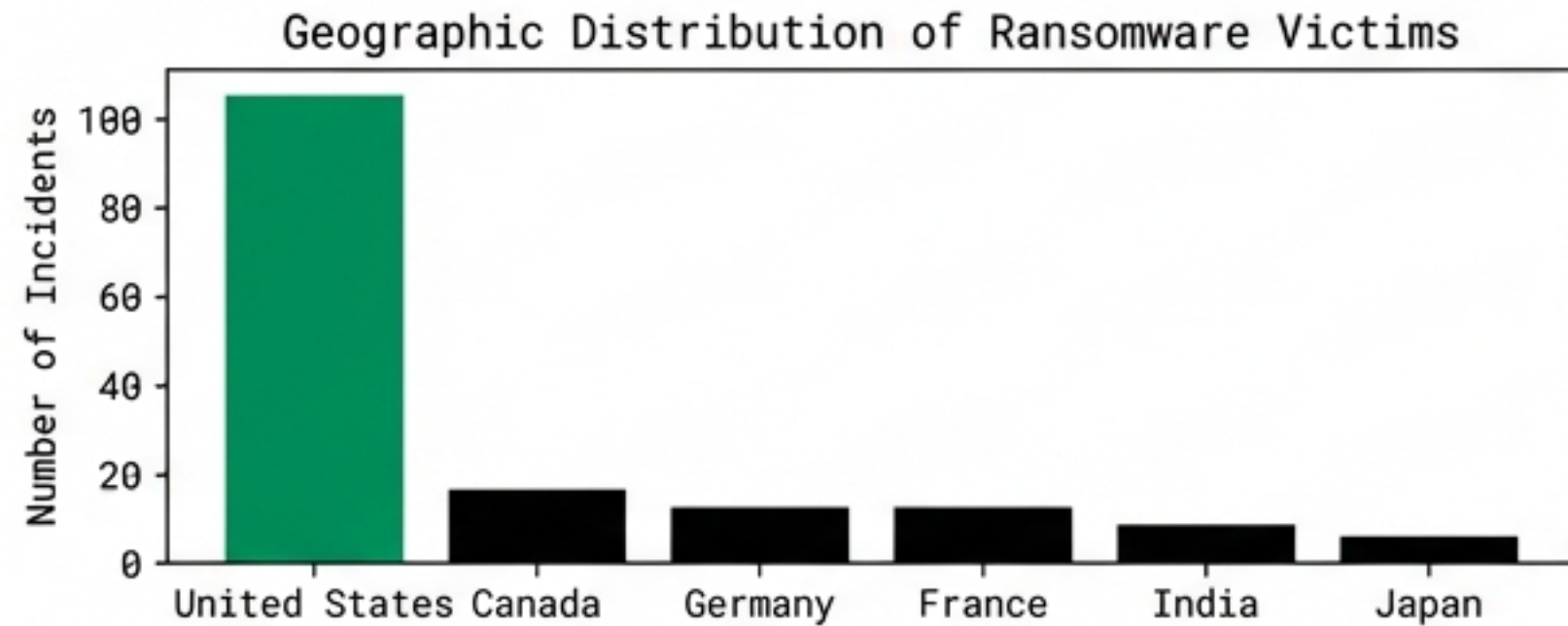
Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Convergence of Scale

Simultaneous **increases** across all vectors driven by **automation** require **integrated fraud** and **cyber defense**.



Regional Risk Assessment: Americas & Asia-Pacific

North America



- Primary Target: **55%** of global ransomware victims (**411 incidents**).
- US alone accounted for **49%** of the global total.

Asia-Pacific (APAC)

+150%

Increase in China-Nexus Activity

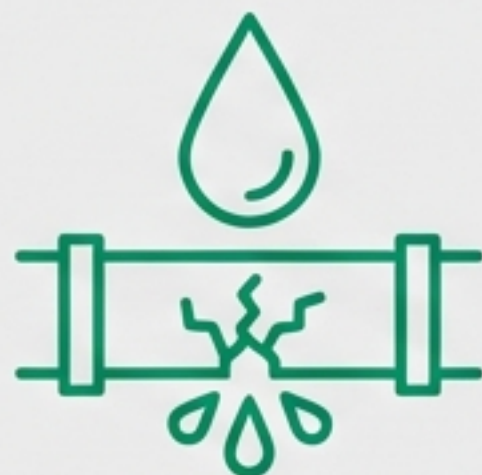
- Groups like **Salt Typhoon** compromising **telecom networks**.
- **Coupang Breach** (South Korea): **34 million user records** exposed.

Key Risk for Bank Leadership: **Regulatory Fallout**

Volume of breaches will trigger aggressive privacy enforcement in **2026**.
'**Secure**' **telecom channels** in APAC must be treated as **monitored**.

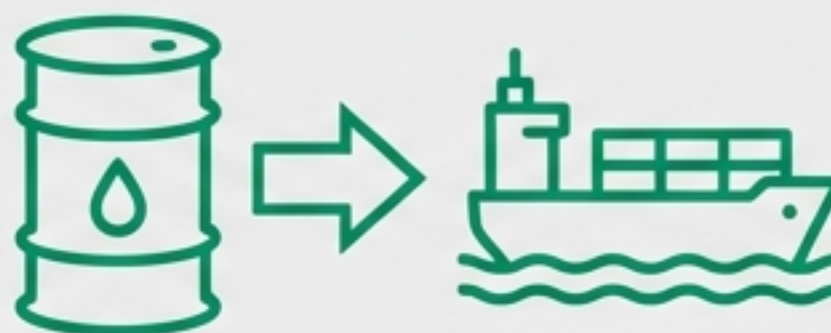
Regional Risk Assessment: EMEA & Global Critical Infrastructure

Denmark: Hybrid Warfare



Tureby Alkestrup Waterworks **physically damaged** (burst pipes) by pro-Russian group Z-Pentest. Escalation to **kinetic impact**.

Venezuela: Energy Paralysis



PDVSA **cyberattack** halted oil cargo. Millions of **barrels stranded**. Blueprint for attacks on EMEA energy suppliers.

Africa: Resource Conflict



Guinea (Simandou Mine): **Cyber-espionage** intersecting with critical mineral supply chains.

Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Kinetic Impact

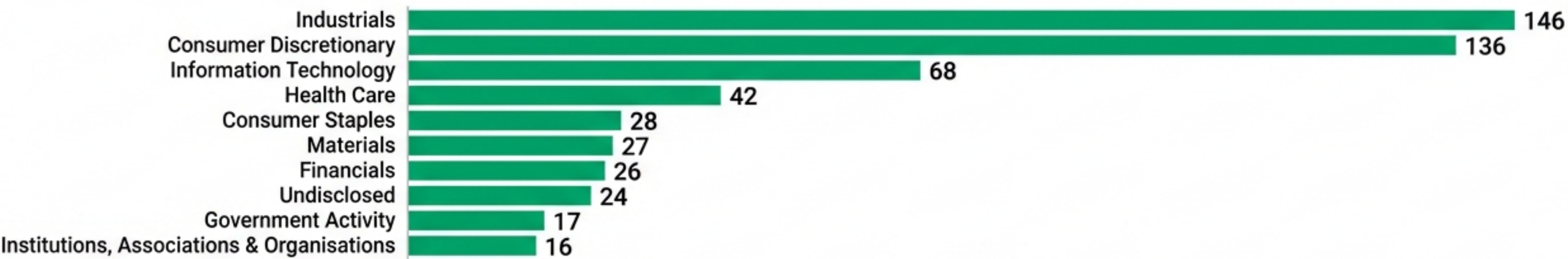
Transition from data theft to **physical destruction**. Re-evaluate insurance regarding 'Acts of War' exclusions.

Adversary Leaderboard: Top Groups & Targeted Sectors

Top Ransomware Groups (December 2025)



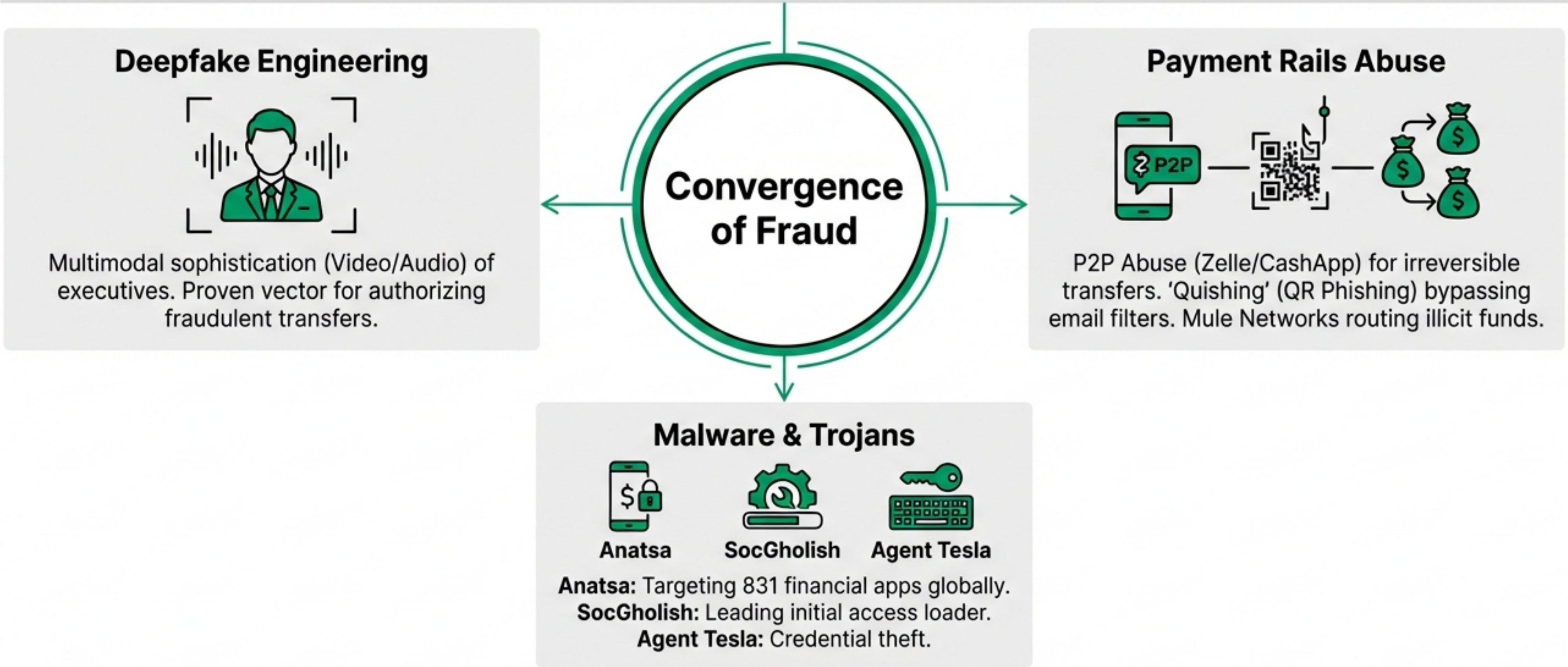
Most Targeted Sectors



Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Supply Chain Concentration

Heavy targeting of Manufacturing (146 victims) poses direct credit risk to commercial loan portfolios in these industries.

Financial Fraud Vector Analysis



Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Authentication Failure

Standard voice/video verification is obsolete. Deepfake technology requires immediate acceleration of **behavioral biometrics**.

Technical Deep Dive: Vulnerabilities & Exploitation

CVE-2025-14847: MongoBleed

Status: **ACTIVE EXPLOITATION**

Critical MongoDB vulnerability allowing database exfiltration without authentication.

CVE-2025-55182: React2Shell

Status: **ACTIVE EXPLOITATION**

Enables botnets/crypto-mining on servers running vulnerable React components.

Technique: ClickFix

Social Engineering. Users tricked into executing malicious PowerShell scripts to 'fix' fake browser errors. Bypasses malware scans.

Perimeter: Zero-Day

Ivanti Connect Secure & Cisco AsyncOS. Continued root access exploitation of network gateways.

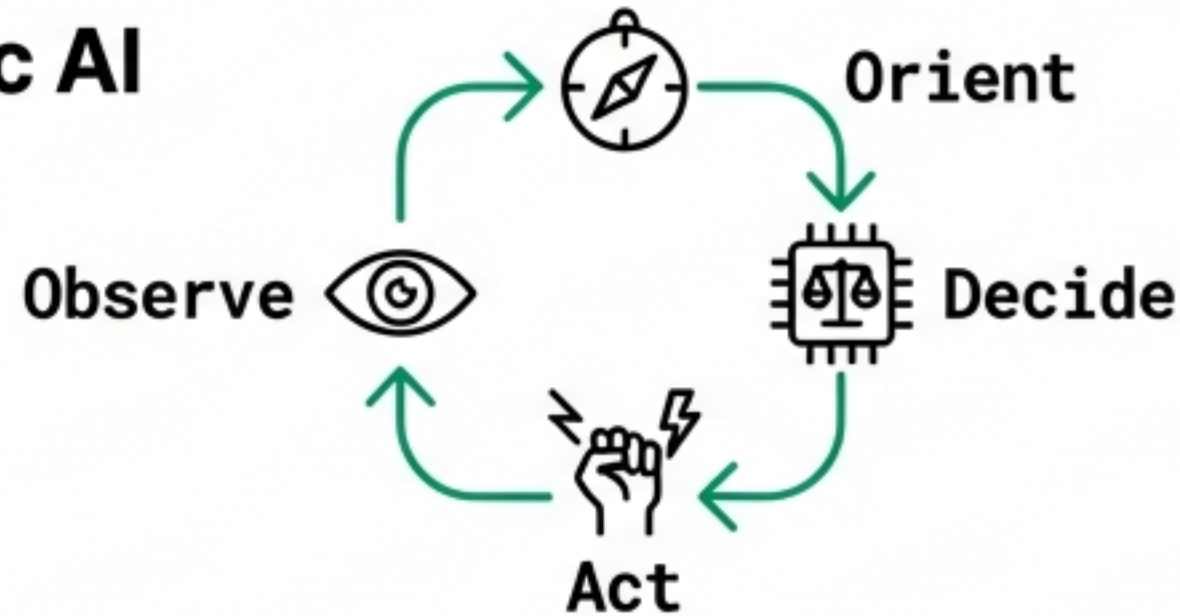
Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Shadow IT

React2Shell highlights risks in modern app frameworks. Security patching must extend beyond OS level to application libraries.

Horizon Scanning: AI Autonomy & Quantum Risk

NOW

Agentic AI



Autonomous bots. Hunt, pivot, and execute attack chains in minutes without human oversight. **"Perfect phishing" lures.**

NEXT

HNDL & Quantum

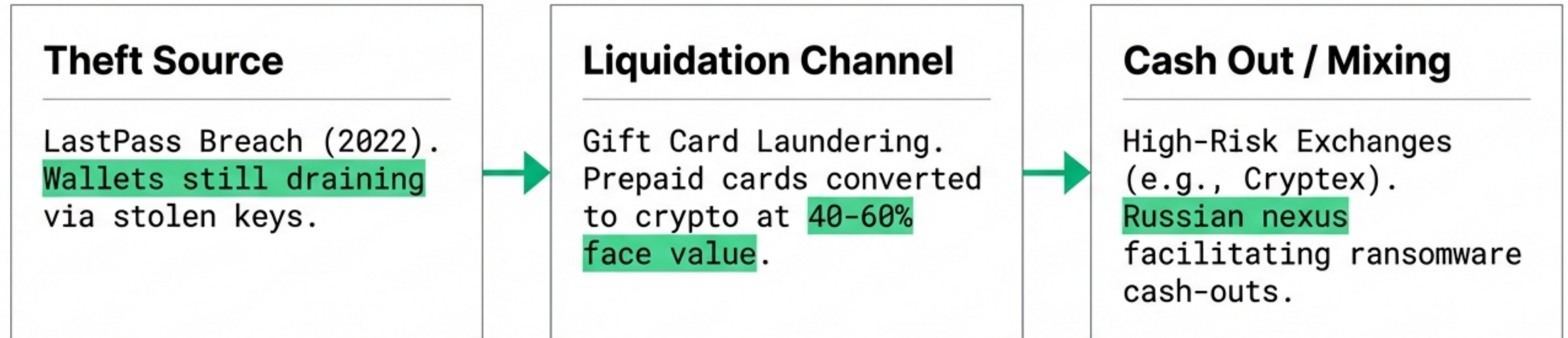
Harvest Now, Decrypt Later.
Adversaries stockpiling encrypted data for future quantum decryption.

Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Obsolescence

Current encryption standards and response playbooks are being outpaced.
"Agentic" threats operate faster than human analysts.

Digital Asset Risk: Laundering & Theft

Flow of Funds



Key Risk for Bank Leadership: Sanctions Evasion

Nexus between Russian exchanges and stolen assets poses severe sanctions risk. Interactions with unregistered digital asset entities must be flagged.